Lecture 13 Outro

Digital methods

Course responsible: Hjalmar Bang Carlsen, Associate Professor SODAS. hc@sodas.ku.dk

Evaluation time

Today

1. What have we learned, what can we take with us?
2. What could/should we have done?
3. Oral exam

What have we learned, what can we take with us?

What **mixed digital methods** is:

1. In terms of data

Repurpose and combine qualitative and quantitative digital data

2. In terms of methods

Combines qual(netnography) and quant(web-scraping)

3. In terms of analysis

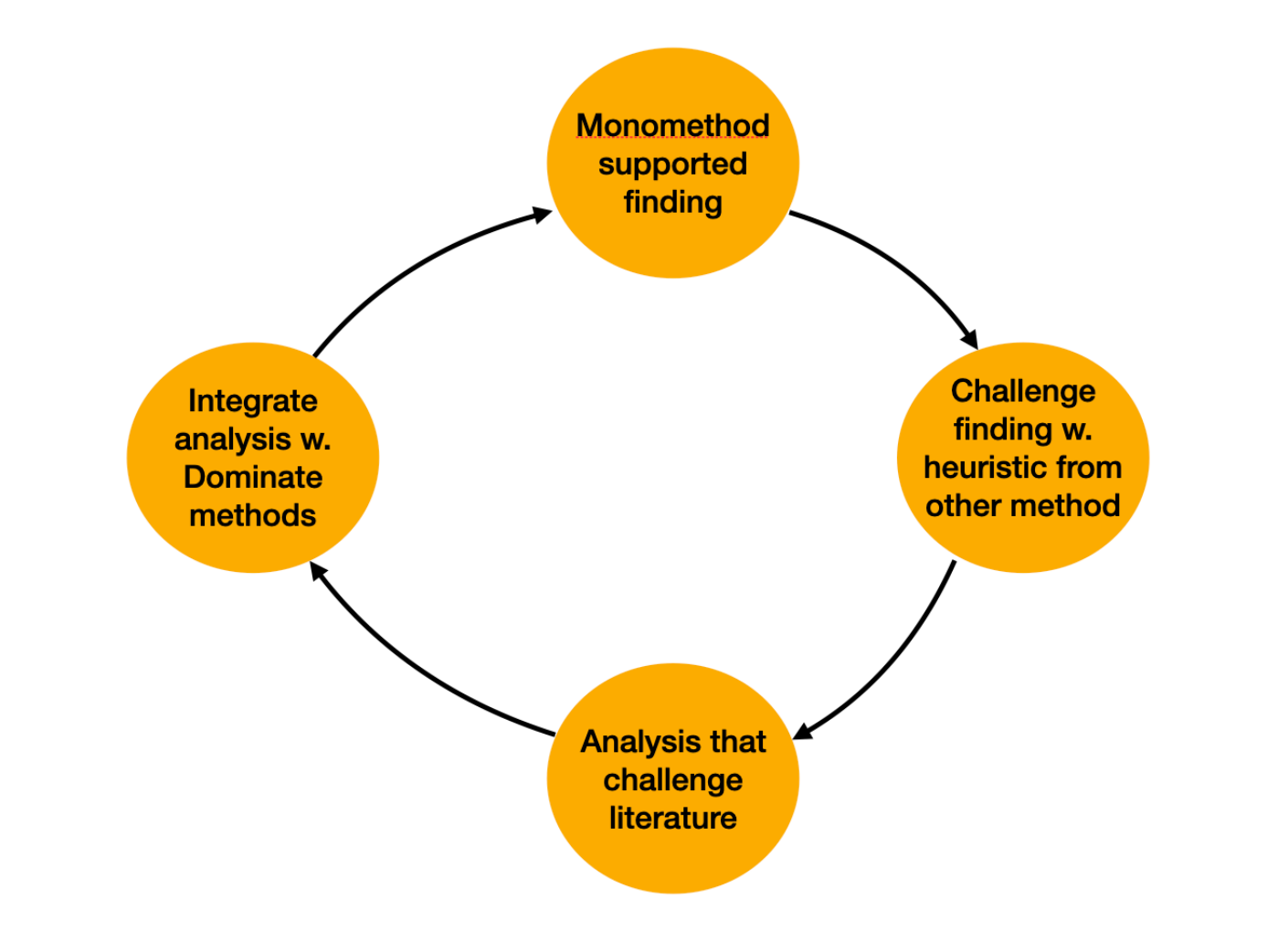
Interpretive AND analytical/statistical(both comp assisted)

How to evaluate, design and collect mixed digital data

Using both qualitative and quantitative methods and criteria to:

1. Scouted for relevant data sites
2. Evaluated, selected a data site
3. Large-scale data collection

Use a mixed digital methods attitude challenge established knowledge



Heuristics - Social Data Science *Data*

Digital Data Quality	Heuristics
Temporal data	setting in motion
Open text data	reconceptualize, changing context, interpretative
Nested data	changing levels, reconceptualize
Relational data	changing context, analogies
Big Data	spilting and lumping

Heuristics - Social Data Science *methods*.

Borrowing methods	Possibility	Assumption	Challenge
Topic modeling/word embedding	large-scale temporal analysis of culture	co-occurrence of words capture meaning	True?
Sentiment analysis	large-scale temporal individual emotional states	Social media message capture emotional states	True?
Network Analysis	whole networks, contagion, comparative network analysis	interactions and relation online = social relations	True?

Use your experience with qual methods to question and investigate weak qual-quant modes of research.

Ethnographic sensibility in working with digital data

1. We can't assume to know what is going on
2. We can't assume to know what people mean
3. We need to learn from and be exposed to a datasite.

Before we can use data for our own analytical purposes.

The practice of qualitative analysis

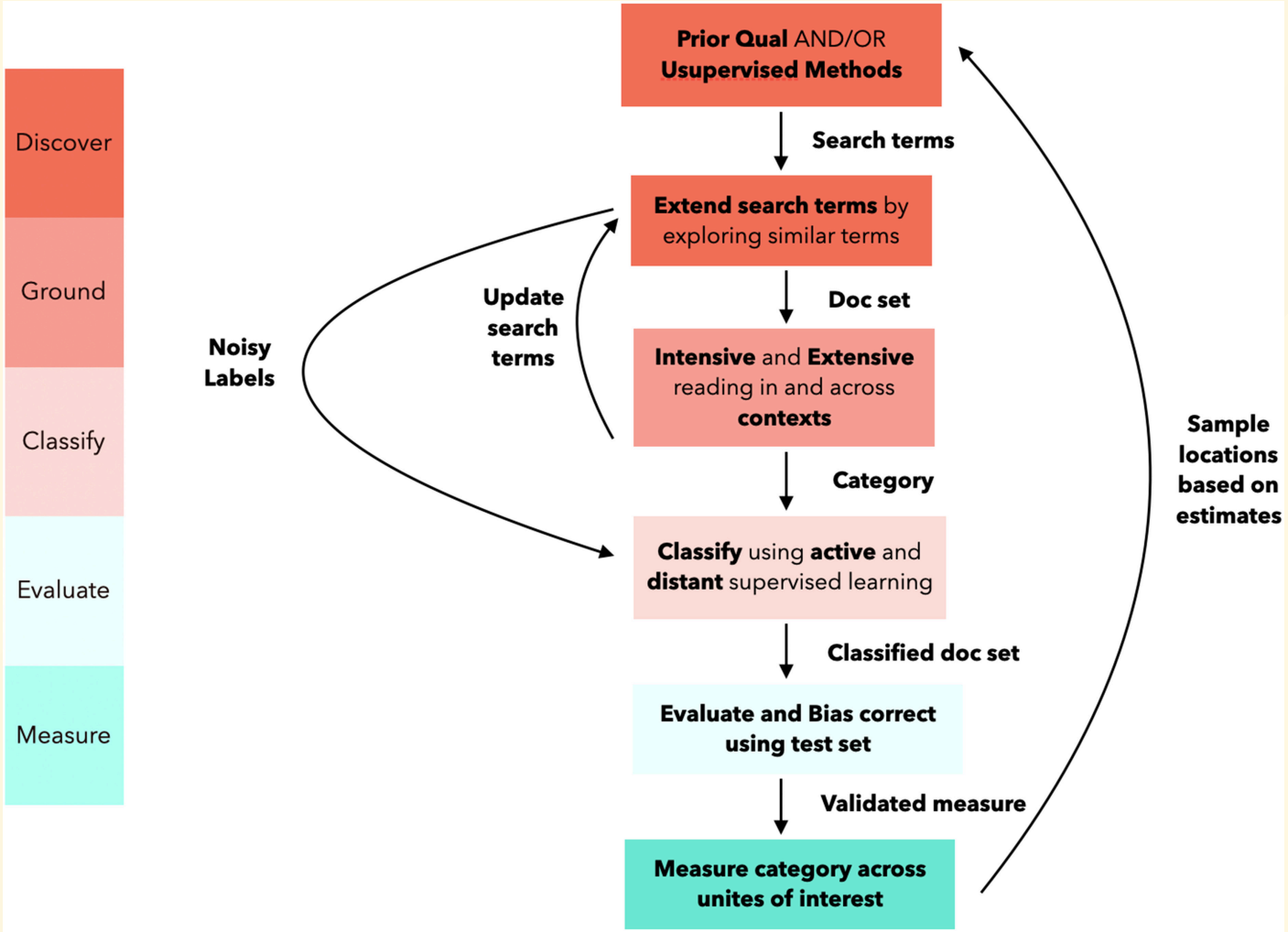
1. How to collect qualitative data
2. How to analyze and code qualitative data
3. How to report on our qualitative findings

Become attached to your object of study

People are fascinating creatures whose meaning making and action call for curious and careful observation.

Combine computational methods and qualitative reading

1. In a way that does not undermine the quality of the qualitative nor the quantitative analysis
2. While still exploiting computational methods to read and code more effectively and informed.
3. And classifying and large amounts of texts


Discover
Ground
Classify
Evaluate
Measure
Prior Qual AND/OR Usupervised Methods
Search terms
Extend search terms by exploring similar terms
Doc set
Intensive and Extensive reading in and across contexts
Category
Classify using active and distant supervised learning
Classified doc set
Evaluate and Bias correct using test set
Validated measure
Measure category across unites of interest
Noisy Labels
Update search terms
Sample locations based on estimates

But still alot to do!

1. beyond sampling with keywords: sentence similarity, document embedding and more
2. Implementation of effective workflow moving from an overview of the data to the sampling and coding of documents.
3. Implementation of Large Language Models in both the discovery and classification steps.

What is missing?!

Visualizations??!?

- Visual displays of data can create maps that in turn can be used to guide qualitative reading.
- Visualization can also be means of theory generation that in turn can be investigated qualitative and quantitatively by other means.

Images!?!

- Images are a super important large scale qualitative data source which demand mixed digital methods approaches.
- Machine learning models are a place where we could do similar methods approaches to that of text.

Oral examination

1. 40min groups of 3 AND 45min for groups of 4.

GROUPS OF 3:
5-7 minutes for presentation, about 30 minutes discussion with Kristoffer and I, 5 min for evaluation.

GROUPS OF 4:
5-8 minutes for presentation, about 30-35 minutes discussion with Kristoffer and I, 5 min for evaluation.

2. Time: 17 and 18 of June.

Oral examination - what to expect

1. Clarifying, critical and curious questions around the topic, concepts, research design, use of methods and findings.
2. You typically can't get a worse grade from your oral performance, so it can only get better.

Oral examination - what to do

1. A chance for you to clarify, sharpen and defend your work!
2. A power-point presentation is optional(display on your laptop)
3. Exploit the oral medium to formulate your project in a interesting and sharp manner.
4. Handle obvious problems in your project
5. Point the conversation in a direction you would like it to

Any very last questions?